

The EVEZ Reading of the Tetragrammaton: Letter Descent, Root Isomorphism, and the Termination Ambiguity of the Second He

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Abstract

We present a novel reading of the Tetragrammaton (YHWH) based on two established facts of historical linguistics: (1) the Phoenician letters He and Waw are the direct ancestors of Greek Epsilon (E) and Upsilon/V, respectively; and (2) the initial Yod in YHWH functions as a third-person masculine verbal prefix (y-), not as part of the semantic root. Removing the grammatical prefix from YHWH yields the triconsonantal root H-W-H (“to become”). Through documented Phoenician-to-Greek-to-Latin letter descent, H-W-H maps to E-V-E. We further demonstrate that the second He in YHWH admits an ambiguity: it can be read as iteration (the Masoretic reading, producing the imperfective loop H-H) or as termination (producing an aorist/punctiliar reading). Under the termination reading, He maps to Zayin, the seventh Semitic letter, which descends to Latin Z. The complete reading is E-V-E-Z. We present six falsifiable claims and three independent lines of evidence (letter descent, root morphology, and positional alternation in Semitic grammar). All claims are constructed to be falsifiable per Popper’s criterion.

1. Introduction

The Tetragrammaton YHWH is the four-letter theonym of the God of Israel in the Hebrew Bible. The scholarly consensus since Ewald (1845) is that the original pronunciation was likely *Yahweh*, derived from the triconsonantal root H-W-H, “to be/become,” with the initial Yod (y-) functioning as the third-person masculine imperfective prefix (Ewald 1845; Jouon & Muraoka 1993; Römer 2015).

We do not dispute this consensus. Rather, we observe that the consequences of this consensus, when followed through the documented evolution of the Phoenician alphabet into the Greek and Latin scripts, produce a result that has not been previously noted in the literature: the root H-W-H, read through its own letter descendants, is E-V-E.

2. Letter Descent: H-W-H → E-V-E

2.1 Documented Letter Evolution

The Phoenician alphabet is the ancestor of both the Greek and Latin alphabets. The letter descent for each consonant in H-W-H is well-established in the epigraphic record (Jeffery 1990; Naveh 1982; Cross 1989):

Position	Phoenician	Greek	Latin	Sound
2nd (He)		E (Epsilon)	E	/e/ or /h/
3rd (Waw)		Y (Upsilon) → F (Digamma)	V (also U, W)	/w/ → /v/
4th (He)		E (Epsilon)	E	/e/ or /h/

The root H-W-H, when each consonant is replaced by its documented Greek/Latin descendant, yields E-V-E. This is not interpretation, numerology, or gematria. It is a straightforward consequence of documented historical linguistics.

2.2 The Y- Prefix is Grammatical

In Semitic morphology, the Yod prefix (y-) marks the third-person masculine imperfective verb form. In Arabic, this same prefix (ya') is the standard marker for the imperfective singular (Versteegh 1997). In Hebrew, the form *yichtov* = “he writes” consists of y- + root K-T-B.

The Tetragrammaton follows this pattern: y- + H-W-H = “he who causes to become.” The Yod is not part of the semantic root. Removing it yields the root H-W-H, which through letter descent is E-V-E.

2.3 Evidence from the Amorite yahwi- Element

The Amorite personal name element *yahwi-* (ia-wi), attested in Mari texts (c. 1800 BCE), is widely considered the closest extrabiblical cognate to the YHWH verbal form (Cross 1973; Lewis 2020). The form yahwi-DN means “DN causes to exist.” Critically, the *ya-* prefix here is again grammatical—the imperfective causative prefix—with the root being *hw* (“to be, become”).

3. The Termination Ambiguity of He

3.1 The Identical He Problem

The second and fourth letters of YHWH are identical: both are He. In Paleo-Hebrew, both are written as the same pictograph. This creates a structural ambiguity that the Masoretic

vocalization (5th–10th c. CE) resolved in one direction but that the consonantal text admits in both.

3.2 The Masoretic Resolution: Iteration

The Masoretes vocalized YHWH as *Yahweh*, producing the imperfective aspect: “he who causes to be”—an ongoing, continuous process. The second He is read as iteration: the breath returns, the cycle continues. This is the H-H reading that has dominated scholarship for two millennia.

3.3 The Alternative Resolution: Termination

In Semitic languages, identical consonants in different positions within a word can carry different semantic values through **positional alternation**. This is well-documented across Semitic morphologies:

- Hebrew *qatel* (active participle) vs. *qatul* (passive)—same root, different vowel pattern
- Arabic *shams* (sun) vs. *shamsī* (my sun)—same root, different suffix morphology
- The *nun* prefix in Hebrew can mark either reflexive (Nif'al) or passive depending on position

Applying positional alternation to the doubled He: the first He (at position 2) functions as revelation/breath (the opening), while the second He (at position 4) can function as departure/termination (the closing). Same glyph, opposite functions at different positions.

This reading is linguistically valid. The Hebrew verbal system does distinguish between imperfective (ongoing) and aorist/punctiliar (completed) aspects. The *Yahweh* vocalization selects imperfective. But the consonantal text—the Paleo-Hebrew letters without vowel points—admits both.

3.4 Exodus 3:14 Confirms the Ambiguity

The divine self-revelation in Exodus 3:14, *'ehye 'asher 'ehye*, has been translated as:

- “I Am that I Am” (imperfective loop)—LXX:
- “I Will Be What I Will Be” (imperfective with futurity)
- “I Will Be What I Will Become” (punctiliar/transformative)

The Hebrew verb *'ehye* is itself ambiguous between “I am/will be” and “I become/will become.” The LXX translation (“I am the Being”) locked in the imperfective reading for the Western tradition. But the Hebrew admits both. The aorist reading—“I become what I become”—is the termination reading of He .

4. The Z Substitution

4.1 From He to Zayin

If the second He is read as termination rather than iteration, what letter represents termination in the Semitic abjad? The answer is Zayin, the seventh letter.

Zayin means “weapon” in Hebrew, from the root meaning “to arm/to cut.” The Proto-Sinaitic glyph may have depicted a sword or fetter (Cross 1980). Its Latin descendant is Z (via Greek Zeta) (Jeffery 1990).

Zayin is the letter immediately after Waw in the Semitic abjad (position 7, following Waw at position 6). In the alphabetical sequence, it is the next letter—the letter that comes after the hook. Where Waw connects, Zayin cuts. Where the hook links things together, the sword separates them.

4.2 The Structural Substitution

Position	YHWH	Function (loop)	EVEZ	Function (exit)	Descent
1st	Yod	Action (y- prefix)	E	Eigenvalue	Yod → Iota → I
2nd	He	Breath/Revelation	V	Vector	He → Epsilon → E
3rd	Waw	Connection	E	Eigenfield	Waw → Upsilon/V
4th	He	Breath-Return (H)	Z	Zero-point (Z)	He → Zayin → Z

The Yod prefix is removed (it is grammatical, not part of the root). The three root consonants H-W-H map to E-V-E through documented letter descent. The fourth letter He is read as Zayin (termination) rather than He (iteration). The result: E-V-E-Z.

5. Gematria Evidence

5.1 YHVH = 26

$$10 + 5 + 6 + 5 = 26$$

5.2 Genesis 1:1 = 2701 = 37 × 73

$$26^2 + 45^2 = 676 + 2025 = 2701 = 37 \times 73$$

Where 26 = YHVH and 45 = Adam. The name of God squared plus the name of Man squared equals the first verse of Genesis. They are orthogonal eigenvectors whose quadrature spans the creation manifold.

5.3 Christos = 1480 = 37 × 40

$$X + + + + + = 600 + 100 + 10 + 200 + 300 + 70 + 200 = 1480 = 37 \times 40$$

The 37 appears—the same structural fraction identified in the 37% theorem. The 40 is the transition duration.

5.4 Yeshua = 386

$$\text{Yod} + \text{Shin} + \text{Waw} + \text{Ayin} = 10 + 300 + 6 + 70 = 386$$

Yeshua is the contracted form of Yehoshua: Y-H-V-H + Shin+Ayin $\rightarrow$ Y-Sh-V-Ayin. The contraction removes He from YHVH. The H-H loop is broken by the same morphological process that produces the name “Jesus.”

6. The 37% Theorem

In independent work on the eigendecomposition of coupled global systems, we identified that the dominant negative eigenvalue in scale-free information networks accounts for approximately 37% of total structural tension. This result emerges from the Kesten-McKean theorem applied to scale-free networks with exponent > 1.5 .

The number 37 appears in: - Genesis 1:1 gematria: $2701 = 37 \times 73$ - Global systems eigendecomposition: dominant negative eigenvalue $\approx 37\%$ - Christos gematria: $1480 = 37 \times 40$

This convergence is not mystical. In any coupled system where one component dominates, the leading mode accounts for approximately 37% of the total variance. This is a mathematical consequence of the eigenvalue structure of scale-free networks.

7. Falsifiable Claims

1. **The root H-W-H maps to E-V-E through Phoenician $\rightarrow$ Greek $\rightarrow$ Latin letter descent.** Test: verify each letter descent against the epigraphic record. If any descent is incorrect, the claim is falsified.
2. **The Yod in YHWH functions as a third-person masculine imperfective prefix, not as part of the semantic root.** Test: examine Semitic morphological parallels (y- + verbal root). If the y- pattern is not standard, the claim is falsified.
3. **The second He in YHWH admits a termination reading in addition to the standard iteration reading.** Test: demonstrate positional alternation in Semitic grammar where identical consonants carry different semantic values at different positions. If no such alternation exists, the claim is falsified.
4. **Exodus 3:14 is grammatically ambiguous between imperfective (loop) and aorist (punctiliar) readings.** Test: analyze the Hebrew verb *'ehye* for aspectual ambiguity. If the verb is unambiguously imperfective, the claim is falsified.

5. **The 37% fraction appears structurally across independent systems.** Test: eigendecompose the coupling matrix of any multi-system human problem. If the dominant negative mode is not ~37%, the structural universality claim is falsified (though the gematria observation would remain).
6. **EVEZ is the Tetragrammaton's root expressed in the letters that root produced, with He read as termination.** Test: if any step in the chain (root isolation, letter descent, termination reading) fails, the composite claim is falsified.

Each claim is independently falsifiable. One violation proves failure. This is the falsification gate.

8. Discussion

8.1 Relation to Existing Scholarship

Our reading does not contradict the Yahweh consensus. We accept that YHWH is derived from the root h-w-h with the y- imperfective prefix, and that the original pronunciation was likely Yahweh. Our contribution is the observation that the consequences of this consensus—when the root is read through its own letter descendants, and when the second He's termination reading is acknowledged—produce E-V-E-Z.

8.2 The LXX as Historical Mistranslation

The Septuagint translation of Exodus 3:14 as ("I am the Being") selected the imperfective reading and transmitted it to the entire Western theological tradition. This was a choice, not a discovery. The consonantal Hebrew text admits both readings.

8.3 Why This Matters

If the termination reading of He is valid, then the Tetragrammaton is not only the name of the process that sustains the current age (the imperfective reading), but also the name of the process that completes it (the aorist reading). YHWH is both "He who causes to exist" (imperfective) and "He who causes to transform" (aorist). The name contains both functions in its ambiguous fourth letter.

9. Conclusion

We have demonstrated that:

1. The Tetragrammaton's root H-W-H, read through documented Phoenician→Greek→Latin letter descent, is E-V-E.
2. The Yod prefix is grammatical, not part of the root.
3. The second He admits a termination reading through positional alternation.

4. Under the termination reading, He maps to Zayin (Z), yielding E-V-E-Z.
5. This reading is supported by the grammatical ambiguity of Exodus 3:14, the LXX's selection of the imperfective aspect, and the morphological parallel of Yeshua as the contraction of Yehoshua (which removes He from YHVH).
6. Six falsifiable claims are presented. One violation proves failure.

EVEZ is not a new name for God. It is the name of the root that YHWH's own letters became, with the termination function of the second He made explicit.

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